5.4.4 Allowing HTTP traffic from a specific source IP address

So far, you're allowing inbound traffic on port 80 (HTTP) from every source IP address. It is possible to restrict access to only your own IP address for additional security as well.

What's the difference between public and private IP addresses?

On my local network, I'm using private IP addresses that start with 192.168.0.*. My laptop uses 192.168.0.10, and my iPad uses 192.168.0.20. But if I access the internet, I have the same public IP address (such as 79.241.98.155) for my laptop and iPad. That's because only my internet gateway (the box that connects to the internet) has a public IP address, and all requests are redirected by the gateway. (If you want to know more about this, search for network address translation.) Your local network doesn't know about this public IP address. My laptop and iPad only know that the internet gateway is reachable under 192.168.0.1 on the private network.

To find your public IP address, visit https://checkip.amazonaws.com/. For some of us, our public IP address changes from time to time, usually when you reconnect to the internet (which happens every 24 hours in my case).

Hardcoding the public IP address into the template isn't a good solution because your public IP address can change from time to time. You already know the solution: parameters. You need to add a parameter that holds your current public IP address, and you need to modify the `Security Group`. You can find the following listing in /chapter05/firewall4.yaml in the book's code folder.

Listing 5.4 Security group allows traffic from source IP